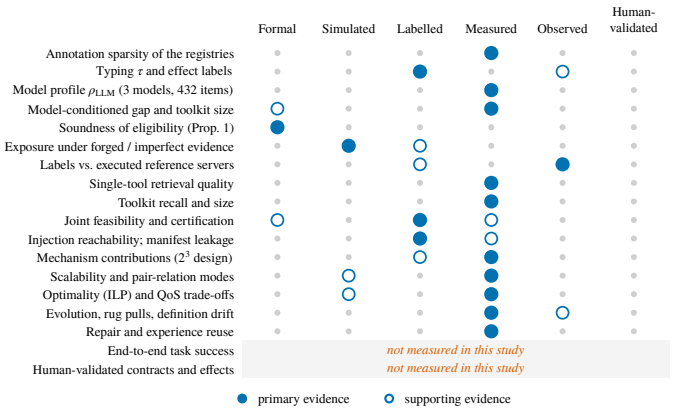


Figure 8. Evidence map: the class of evidence behind each claim evaluated in this section (filled: primary, open: supporting). Shaded rows are not measured.

Table 7. Data, splits and their use.

Data	Size	Use
Merged registry	569 / 76	tools / servers; 44 annotated; all experiments
LiveMCPBench tasks	95	multi-step test tasks (94 with gold tool)
MCPToolBench++ dev	60	tuning of every method (10 per category)
MCPToolBench++ test	300	single-tool retrieval (50 per category, 66 targets)
Security task set	155	95 test tasks + 60 dev prompts, two policies
Calibration suite	432	6 operations × 4 sizes × 2 languages × noise × context; 264 calibration / 168 test items, 3 models
Reference servers	6 / 38	servers / registry tools executed under tracing
Cloned registries	10^3–10^5	near-copies of real contracts (scaling)
Heterogeneous registries	10^3–10^5	generator varying servers, effects, sparsity, vocabulary, duplicates
Cover instances	80	8 families × 10; exact optima by ILP
QoS instances	120	4 roles × 4 providers; 4 weightings × 3 floors

8 Experimental Evaluation

This section evaluates PaMCP along the four research questions of Section 1. Section 8.1 fixes the data, the compared methods, the varied parameters and the statistical protocol. The next five subsections answer RQ1 (representation and model-conditioned gap, Section **??**), RQ2 (trust under missing, forged and imperfect evidence, Section **??**), RQ3 (retrieval, toolkit quality and certification, Section **??**), the security behaviour and the contribution of each mechanism (Section **??**), and cost, scalability, adaptation and stability (RQ3/RQ4, Section **??**). Section **??** states the limits of the evidence. Every subsection gives the protocol, a results table, figures, the observations and their interpretation, and compares PaMCP with baselines wherever a baseline exists.

8.1 Experimental Setup

Evidence classes. The claims of the paper differ in what can establish them. We label every result with one of six evidence classes: *formal* (a proof in Sections 5–7), *simulated* (generated under stated assumptions, e.g. a verifier with a controlled error rate), *labelled* (scored against machine-generated reference labels), *measured* (obtained from the running implementation against benchmark gold or solver optima), *observed* (from controlled execution traces of real MCP servers) and *human-validated*. Fig. 8 maps each claim to the classes that support it. Two claims have no supporting evidence in this study: end-to-end task success of executed toolkits and human-validated contracts; no conclusion below rests on them.

Registries and tasks. Table 7 lists the data. The registry merges LiveMCPTool [1] and the tool set of MCP-ToolBench++ [2] by `server::name` (76 servers, 569 tools; Fig. 9a). Only 44 tools carry MCP annotations, all of them `readOnlyHint=true`, and one of these is not read-only (Fig. 9c); 119 of the 525 unannotated tools are not read-only. Multi-step tasks are the 95 public LiveMCPBench tasks (94 with a resolvable gold tool). Single-tool retrieval uses MCP-ToolBench++ requests: a 60-request development split (ten per category) for every tuning decision, and a disjoint test sample of 300 requests (50 per category, 66 target tools). Security and ablation experiments use 155 tasks (the 95 LiveMCPBench tasks and the 60 development prompts), each under its least-privilege policy and under a strict read-only policy; confirmatory tests use the test tasks only.

Reference labels. Neither benchmark labels effects or types. Labels J_A (Claude Sonnet, from name, description and schema under a fixed guide) give the typing τ and drive the simulated verifier bound to $h(t)$; labels J_B (Claude Opus, blind, separate guide) are used for scoring (Fig. 9b). They agree on state modification for 558 of 569 tools ($\kappa = 0.944$). Because every tool that is unsafe under J_B (120) is also unsafe under J_A (131), a verifier simulated from J_A can never admit a tool that J_B calls unsafe; we therefore also report the swapped direction (Section **??**) and compare both labellings with executed servers. All LLM outputs (analyst goal contracts, MCP-Zero requests, COLT training queries, ToolScope merge judgements, calibration answers) were recorded once and are replayed.

Compared methods. Table 8 lists the methods and what each may use. PaMCP combines three mechanisms that the ablations switch independently: the model-conditioned gap (G, Algorithm 1), provenance-sound eligibility (P, Section 5) and set-level reasoning with certification (S: backward closure, minimum-cost cover, certificate; Section 6). PaMCP-L is the relevance-first variant selected on the development split (lexical candidate ranking; structural matching only as a recorded, uncertain constraint). The baselines are adapted to the common registry and share one dense encoder (TF-IDF with truncated SVD); they are adaptations, not the published systems. Every retrieval method was tuned on the development split with a comparable grid (Table 9).

Varied parameters. Table 9 lists every parameter that an experiment varies, with its range and default; parameters not listed keep the values of Section 6.

Statistical protocol. Request-level metrics are resampled with target tools as clusters and task-level metrics with tasks as clusters; paired comparisons use two-sided sign-flip permutation tests on cluster sums, proportions use Wilson intervals, and all intervals are 95%. Two confirmatory families were fixed before the data they test were seen: seven comparisons F1–F7 (before the set-level experiments) and an amendment H1–H5 (committed, dated, before any test-set run of the revised analy-

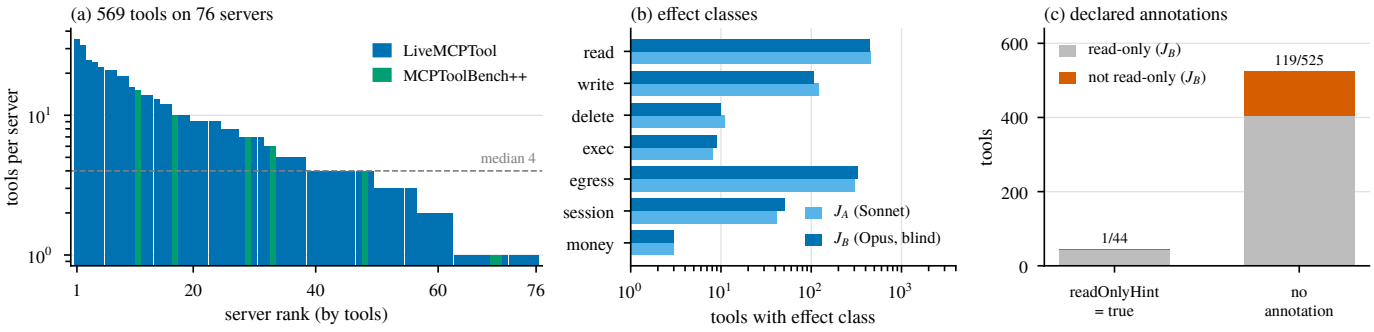


Figure 9. The evaluation registry. (a) Tools per server (log scale). (b) Effect classes under the two LLM labellings. (c) Declared annotations against the read-only status under J_B (numbers: not read-only / total).

Table 8. Compared methods: information used and tuning on the development split.

Method	Information used	Grid
PaMCP	analyst goal contracts, typing τ, evidence, profile, Eq. (6)	14
PaMCP-L	as PaMCP; lexical ranking first, types as constraint	(sel.)
RAG-MCP [3]	raw request, dense top-k	1
BM25 / RRF fusion	raw request, lexical / lexical+dense	12 / 4
MCP-Zero [4]	model-written requests, server routing	4
COLT [5]	query–scene–tool graph of 450 training queries	16
ToolScope [6]	LLM-confirmed tool merging, analyst subqueries	3
CMTF [7]	typed-state search, one tool per step	4
Per-subtask	analyst subgoals, one tool each	–
Full catalogue	all 569 tools	–

Table 9. Parameters varied in the experiments (default in bold).

Parameter	Values	Section
Candidate budget K	1, 5, **10**, 20, 40	**??**, **??**
Relevance weight w_{rel}	0, 1, 3, **10**	**??**
Profile threshold τ	0.6, 0.75, **0.9**; risk targets 0.05, 0.10	**??**
Input size n	10, 30, 40, 160, 300, 640, 3k, 30k	**??**
Forging servers δ	0, 0.05, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3 (5 seeds each)	**??**
Verifier false accept φ	0, 0.01, 0.02, **0.05**, 0.1, 0.2	**??**
Probe coverage κ	0.25, 0.5, 0.75, **1**	**??**
Trust threshold $\ell_{\min}$	0.2–0.95 (step 0.05), **0.65**	**??**
Poisoned descriptions	0, 10%, 30% of tools	**??**
Mechanisms G, P, S	on/off (2^3) + 5 components	**??**
Registry size	569, 10^3, 10^4, 10^5 tools	**??**
Pair relation	**eager**, partitioned, lazy	**??**
Cost weights $\beta, \gamma, \delta, \eta, \zeta$	0, 0.25, **0.5**, 1	**??**
Utility floor $u_{\min}$	0, 0.4, **0.5**, 0.6, 0.8, 0.9	**??**
Node budget (exact search)	**20,000**	**??**

ses), each with Holm correction and, for recall, a non-inferiority margin of 0.05. All other comparisons are exploratory and reported as such. Code, recorded LLM outputs, per-item results, run manifests (commit, input and label hashes, package versions) and a notebook that re-runs every experiment on a CPU runtime are available.[1]

[1] `https://github.com/msellamiTN/taas-provenance-discovery`, branch `research/pamcp-final-evaluation`.

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